

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Manager, AI Neobank.*

Positioning, fintech-native PM with 13 years in regulated products, a payment startup taken to acquisition, and AI platform delivery across defence and public sector.

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Dear Hiring Team at Bjak,

I am applying for the Technical Product Manager role on your AI Neobank. The brief is unusually honest about what this work actually demands: money must be correct, AI is a means not the goal, and the PM owns the vertical from strategy through production. That framing resonates with me because it matches the environments I have worked in, not just the way I describe product management in interviews.

My closest reference point is Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P payment product I co-founded and took from zero to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem run by Sparkasse. Payments that move real money inside a regulated banking rail force a different level of precision on ledgering, reconciliation, failure handling, and compliance than most consumer products require. I learned early that a beautiful UX on top of a flaky settlement layer is not a product, it is a liability. That lesson has shaped how I approach every financial product since.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS defence programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists. The work included deciding where AI genuinely improved an outcome and where deterministic systems had to stay in control, a distinction the Bjak posting names explicitly. I also introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable, which matters when the underlying system is both mission-critical and multinational. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I held the Deputy IT Security Officer role while simultaneously migrating a bare-metal analytics platform into containers and shipping a full UI relaunch, regulatory constraints and delivery pressure at the same time, which is the normal condition at a fintech scaling across multiple Southeast Asian markets.

The insurance domain is one I know from two sides: as a product owner at CLINET (a mobile patient app interfacing with hospital information systems) and as a PM at EMIL Group, where I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production for a B2B SaaS platform serving insurers, reinsurers, and brokers. I cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week there. Bjak's insurance vertical is not unfamiliar territory.

On the AI side I work daily with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, and n8n for agentic workflows. I have shipped products that use LLMs for evaluation, triage, and automation, and I have also killed AI features mid-delivery because the failure mode was unacceptable for the user context. Knowing when not to use AI is the harder discipline, and the posting singles it out for good reason.

I am available within four weeks of an offer and comfortable working across Southeast Asian time zones from Berlin. I would welcome a conversation about which vertical you would have me own first.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
